22.4.4 Government Initiatives

In order to preserve the plants and animals, government has taken lot of initiatives and some acts have also been passed to protect them. For example, Project Tiger is a wildlife conservation project initiated in India in 1972 to protect the Bengal Tiger. It was launched on 1st April 1973 and has become one of the most successful wildlife conservation ventures. Corbett National Park was the first National Park in India to be covered under project Tiger. Due to 'Project Tiger' the population of Tiger has increased in India from 1400 in 2006 to 2967 in 2018. Apart from this, government has enacted the following Acts.

1. Madras Wildlife Act, 1873.
2. All India Elephant Preservation Act, 1879.
3. The Wild Bird and Animal Protection Act, 1912.
4. Bengal Rhinoceros Preservation Act, 1932.
5. All India Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.
6. Environmental Protection Act, 1986.

22.5 Red Data Book

The Red Data Book is the file for recording rare and endangered species of animals, plants and fungi. Even some local sub-species that exist within the territory of a state or country are recorded in red data books. Red data book gives important data for observational studies and monitoring programmes on habits and habitats of rare and endangered species. This book is created to identify and protect the species which are about to extinct.

Red Data Book is maintained by the International Union for Conservation of Nature. It is an international organization working in the field of nature conservation and sustainable use of natural resources. It was founded in 1964 with the aim of maintaining a complete record of every species that ever lived. The Red Data Book classifies species mainly into three categories namely, threatened, not threatened and unknown. This book also has information as to why a species has become extinct along with the population trends and its distribution.

The Red Data Book contains colour-coded information sheets like black for species which are extinct, red for species that are endangered and so on. They are arranged according to the extinction risk of many species and subspecies. The following figure gives the colour coded information.

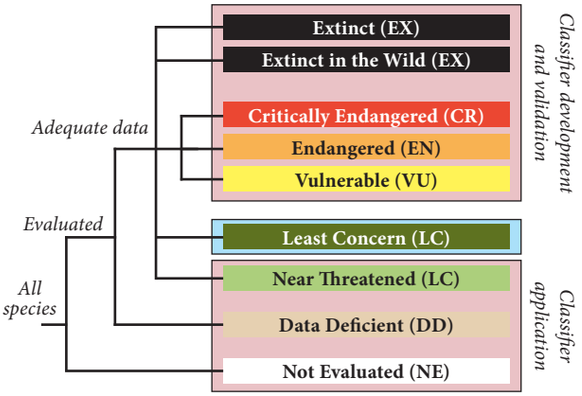


Figure 22.8 IUCN Red List Categories

DO YOU KNOW?

IUCN – International Union for Conservation of Nature
WWF – World Wildlife Fund
ZSI – Zoological Survey of India
BRP – Biosphere Reserve Programme
CPCB – Central Pollution Control Board

22.5.1 Advantages of the Red Data Book

- It helps to evaluate the population of a particular species.
- The data given in this book can be used to evaluate the species at the global level.
- The risk of a species becoming globally extinct can be estimated with the help of this book.
- It provides guidelines for implementing measures for protecting endangered species.

22.5.2 Disadvantages of the Red Data Book

- The information available in the Red Data Book is incomplete. Many extinct species are not updated in this book.
- The source of the book's data has been speculated.

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